[METRIC]

A-A-696B
February 16, 1999
SUPERSEDING
A-A-696A
September 8, 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

Towel, Paper

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers general use disposable folded sheet paper towels.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

Type I. - Singlefold towel

Type II. - Multifold towel
Size 1
Size 2

Type III.- C-fold towel

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Material. Paper towels furnished under this description shall be made from paper conforming to the characteristics of Table I. The product shall contain a minimum of 40% Post-consumer recovered material as defined by the Paper Products Recovered Materials Advisory Notice II (Paper RMAN II), unless otherwise specified in the contract or ordering document.

3.2 Dimensions. Paper towels of the type and size specified shall conform to the dimensions of Table II.

3.3 Construction. Type I and type II paper towels shall be interlocked to facilitate easy dispensing. Types I and III paper towels shall dispense satisfactorily from dispensing cabinets designed in accordance with Commercial Item Description A-A-2380, or as specified in the invitation to bid. (To be deemed satisfactory, towels shall dispense one at a time.)

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data that may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, FSS-2FYEE, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 8540

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3.4 Odor. Towels shall have no disagreeable odor when dry or wet. To test for odor when wet, soak a single towel in distilled water at room temperature for 2 minutes. Remove the towel from the water and smell the towel at a distance of 304 - 610 mm (12 - 24 inches). Any disagreeable odor shall be cause for rejection.

TABLE I
Physical Requirements

Characteristic	Requirement	TAPPI Test Method
Basis weight (24x36-500), Grammage, g/m^2 (pounds)	40.7-48.8 (25-30)	T 410
Water absorption 0.1 ml, seconds (max)	100	T 432
Tensile strength 1/ N/100 mm (oz/in), avg. of both directions (min)		
Dry	29.4 (27)	T 404 2/
Wet	8.7 (8)	T 456

1/ *before testing according to T 456, samples of towels shall be placed in* a 105°C oven for 10-12 minutes and then conditioned according to T 402.

2/ T 494 may be used in lieu of T 404.

TABLE II
Sizes and areas

Type	Area (min.) cm^2 (sq. in.)	Smaller dimension cm (inches)	Fold depth cm (inches)
I	638.7 (99)	23.5±1.3 (9-1/4±1/2)	14.0±1.3 (5-1/2±1/2)
II, Size 1	548.3 (85)	23.5±1.3 (9-1/4±1/2)	8.0±0.3 (3-1/8±1/8)
II, Size 2	838.5 (130)	23.5±1.3 (9-1/4±1/2)	6.7±0.3 (2-5/8±1/8)
III	838.5 (130)	25.7±1.3 (10-1/8±1/2)	10.2±1.3 (4±1/2)

3.5 Surface finish and formation. Towels shall have a uniform formation and shall have a finish produced by creping or embossing.

3.6 Bleaching. To obtain an acceptable brightness, a chemical bleaching process may be used. Unless otherwise specified in the ordering data (See Section 7), the bleaching process shall not include the use of chlorine, chlorine dioxide, or hypochlorite. Certification of compliance shall be made available upon request by the Government.

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3.7 Workmanship. Towels shall be free of holes, tears, wrinkles and other defects affecting appearance or serviceability. Edges shall be clean cut. Towels having a gritty, sandpapery feel shall not be acceptable.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE.

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. Statistical Process Control (SPC) techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3/American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1,B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. Objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy, techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

5.3 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

5.4 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI)/American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.5 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and performance characteristics shall be S-3 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The lot size for visual/dimensional characteristics shall be expressed in units of towels, with the sample unit being one towel. The inspection level for performance characteristics shall be S-1 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The lot size for performance characteristics shall be expressed in units of packages, with the sample unit being one package. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

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6. PACKAGING. Preservation, packaging, packing, marking and palletization shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES.

7.1 Part Identification Number_(PIN). The following part identification numbering procedure is for government purposes and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

AA696 - 1: This example describes a Type I Singlefold paper towel

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+---------- Type I – Singlefold towel

7.2 Sources of Referenced Documents.

7.2.1 Government Publications. Copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions may be obtained from the General Services Administration, Specification Section (3FP-E), Suite 8100, L'Enfant Plaza SW, Washington, DC 20407.

7.2.2 TAPPI test methods may be obtained from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, Technology Park/PO Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

7.2.3 ANSI/ASQC methods may be obtained from American Society for Quality Control, PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.2.4 Paper RMAN II may be found in the Federal Register, Vol. 63, Number 109, dated June 8, 1998. You may order copies via the RCRA Hotline at (800) 424-9346.

7.3 Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
Type and size.
Dispenser model.
Bleaching requirement.
Preservation, packaging, packing, marking and palletization.

7.4 National Stock Numbers (NSNs). The following is a list of NSNs that correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with the CID.

NSN	NSN	NSN
8540-00-262-7178	8540-01-359-0798	8540-01-055-6134
8540-00-291-0389	8540-01-359-0799	
8540-00-291-0392	8540-01-359-0800	

7.5. Key Words. Towel, Paper, Singlefold, C-fold, Multi fold.

MILITARY INTERESTS: None **PREPARING ACTIVITY: GSA-FSS**

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